PHILIPPINE STARTUP CHALLENGE XI

PRIORI++

JUMI

CONCEPT NOTE

I. SUMMARY

Jumi is a two-sided employment matching platform that helps Filipino jobseekers and employers discover, assess, and connect with potentially compatible opportunities. Rather than treating recruitment as a one-way application process, Jumi recommends candidates and vacancies to both parties, explains their compatibility, and opens private communication when interest is mutual.

The opportunity arises from a persistent mismatch in the Philippine labor market. The Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) 2023–2024 Integrated Survey on Labor and Employment (ISLE) reported approximately 1.72 million applicants for 455,593 vacancies, yet 34.2% of vacancies were hard to fill. Jumi responds to the discovery and information gaps within this broader problem; it does not claim that matching technology alone can solve unemployment or skills shortages.

Its proposed distinction is explainable, two-sided compatibility: skills, experience, compensation, location, and work arrangements are assessed together; essential requirements are distinguished from preferences; and projects, internships, certifications, and portfolios can provide additional evidence of capability. Jumi will launch with entry-level jobseekers and participating employers, using a two-sided freemium model and a phased six-month pilot supported by a preliminary ₱430,000 budget.

II. BACKGROUND OF THE PROBLEM

Unemployment and recruitment difficulties coexist in the Philippines. PSA figures cited in the original concept note place unemployment at approximately 3.1 million people (6.0%) in July 2026. In the 2023–2024 ISLE, roughly four applicants competed per recorded vacancy, yet 34.2% of vacancies were classified as hard to fill. The preceding 2021–2022 survey reported 51.5% difficult-to-fill vacancies, with insufficient applicants, skills gaps, and salary expectations among reported factors. These indicators point to multiple causes of hiring difficulty rather than a simple shortage of applicants.

Discovery remains fragmented. The 2023–2024 ISLE reported establishments using employee referrals (76.3%), walk-in applications (55.6%), word of mouth (37.2%), and job portals (32.6%). These channels can be effective, but reliance on existing networks can disadvantage applicants who are newly entering the workforce. The same original concept note reports that people aged 15–24 accounted for 43.0% of unemployed Filipinos in July 2026 while representing 13.9% of the labor force.

Conventional screening can also obscure potentially viable matches. Years of experience may be a useful signal, but entry-level applicants can demonstrate relevant competencies through internships, academic work, certifications, and portfolios. On the employer side, limited visibility into candidates' salary expectations, location preferences, and skills can make it difficult to distinguish non-negotiable gaps from negotiable differences.

Jumi therefore addresses a specific information and connection problem: helping both sides identify opportunities, understand why a match may or may not work, and make their own informed decisions. It does not automatically waive hiring requirements or guarantee placements.

III. PROPOSED STARTUP SOLUTION

Jumi combines personalized discovery with a mutual-interest interaction model inspired by dating applications such as Bumble. Both parties create structured profiles; jobseekers describe competencies and preferences, while employers identify vacancy requirements, compensation, location, and work arrangements. Recommendations surface potentially compatible profiles and vacancies without requiring either side to search solely through keywords.

Core Responsibilities:

- Two-sided discovery: jobseekers receive vacancy recommendations and employers receive candidate recommendations based on both parties' information.
- Explainable compatibility: an overall score is accompanied by a factor-level breakdown across skills, experience, compensation, location, and work arrangement, making mismatches visible rather than hiding them behind a binary decision.
- Flexible qualification evaluation: essential criteria are separated from preferred qualifications, while internships, projects, certifications, and portfolios can support a fuller assessment of applicants.
- Mutual-interest matching: each party independently expresses interest through a swipe-style interface; a match unlocks private messaging to discuss interviews, assessments, and next steps.
- Two-Sided Compatibility Analytics: Employers can review aggregated insights on candidate qualifications, salary expectations, and work preferences, while jobseekers can identify potential skill gaps, unmet requirements, and possible reasons for unsuccessful matches.

Aggregated, appropriately protected matching data may later support broader labor-market intelligence about recurring skill, experience, compensation, and work-arrangement mismatches. Such analytics are an expansion opportunity, not a prerequisite for the initial matching experience.

Sustainable Development Goals (SDG)

Jumi primarily aligns with SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), particularly Targets 8.5 and 8.6, through more accessible employment discovery and connections for young jobseekers. It also supports SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities), particularly Target 10.2, by making nontraditional evidence of competencies more visible. These are intended contributions rather than demonstrated outcomes

IV. OBJECTIVES

General objective: Develop and pilot a two-sided employment matching platform that improves discovery, explains compatibility, and enables informed mutual-interest connections between jobseekers and employers.

- Build an MVP with profiles, vacancy and candidate recommendations, mutual-interest matching, and private messaging.
- Evaluate compatibility using at least five factors—skills, experience, compensation, location, and work arrangements—and show interpretable factor-level explanations.
- Distinguish required from preferred qualifications and surface relevant alternative evidence of competence.
- Introduce analytics dashboards for employers to assess candidate-pool trends and for jobseekers to identify qualification gaps and potential reasons for unmatched interest, after validating the core matching workflow.
- Pilot the platform with jobseekers and employers; assess usability, recommendation relevance, clarity of compatibility explanations, mutual-match rates, and user satisfaction.

Specific numerical success thresholds for adoption, matching, and retention will be defined before pilot implementation.

V. TARGET MARKET/BENEFICIARIES

Primary users

- Jobseekers: graduating students, fresh graduates, entry-level applicants, and early-career professionals seeking relevant openings and a way to demonstrate skills beyond formal work experience. Their principal benefits are more targeted discovery, transparent compatibility feedback, and an opportunity to initiate connections based on mutual interest.
- Employers: businesses, hiring managers, HR teams, and recruiters filling entry-level or junior roles. They benefit from candidate recommendations, clearer distinctions between essential and preferred qualifications, and aggregated insights into the talent pool. Organization accounts can support multiple recruiters working under one company.

Secondary beneficiaries

Universities and career placement offices may use Jumi as an additional route to employers and graduates. Workforce development organizations and policymakers could eventually benefit from responsibly aggregated, anonymized information on recurring recruitment gaps, subject to sufficient data quality and privacy safeguards.

VI. VALUE PROPOSITION

Jumi helps both sides answer not only "Are we a match?" but "Why might we be a match, and which differences matter?" For jobseekers, this means opportunities that reflect skills and preferences and greater visibility for project-based or internship experience. For employers, it means a more contextual view of candidates and information about how hiring expectations compare with available talent.

Jumi does not position matching algorithms, job recommendations, or messaging as entirely new. Its proposed advantage is the combined experience of two-sided assessment, explainable mismatches, flexible qualification evaluation, and mutual-interest communication. The platform preserves human discretion: applicants decide whether to pursue a role, and employers retain hiring decisions.

VII. BUSINESS MODEL

Jumi will adopt a two-sided freemium model: essential discovery, compatibility assessments, a limited daily number of swipes, mutual matching, and private messaging remain free for both jobseekers and employers. Optional premium features for both jobseekers and employers support sustainable revenue generation.

Revenue streams

- Jobseeker subscriptions: Increased or unlimited swipes, advanced filters, enhanced profile visibility, detailed compatibility analytics, and premium matching features such as seeing who expressed interest and Super Swipes.
- Employer subscriptions: Increased swipe limits, advanced candidate filters, detailed compatibility and candidate-pool analytics, and premium matching features such as seeing interested applicants and Super Swipes.
- Organization plans: tiered subscriptions for shared company recruitment workflows, with multiple authorized HR users and possible limits based on recruiter seats, active vacancies, and tools.
- One-time purchases: optional swipe packs or temporary profile/vacancy visibility boosts for users who do not need a recurring plan.

Pricing, free-tier swipe limits, paid conversion, and willingness to pay will be validated through pilot research. Revenue is expected to support hosting, maintenance, customer support, ongoing development, and growth. Core matching and messaging remain accessible to avoid undermining the two-sided network.

VIII. MARKET ANALYSIS

Market need and initial focus

The PSA figures cited above establish a sizable labor-market problem and substantial recruitment activity, but unemployed-person counts should not be equated with Jumi's obtainable market. Reach will depend on digital access, employer participation, industry coverage, and user adoption. Jumi's initial serviceable segment is Philippine fresh graduates and early-career applicants paired with organizations recruiting for entry-level and junior roles.

The combination of hard-to-fill vacancies and reliance on referrals, walk-ins, and word of mouth suggests an opportunity for improved discovery. Jumi's hypothesis is that transparent, mutual compatibility assessment can improve the quality of initial connections; this must be tested against actual recruitment outcomes.

Competition and positioning

Jumi will compete with established recruitment services such as JobStreet, LinkedIn, Kalibrr, Indeed, and Bossjob, which already offer substantial listings, candidate discovery, recruiter tools, and, in some cases, recommendations or messaging. Jumi should not claim exclusivity over these functions. Its proposed differentiation is the integrated emphasis on both parties' preferences, understandable mismatch explanations, holistic evidence of capability, and mutual opt-in before conversation.

Go-to-market

Initial acquisition will target universities, student organizations, career placement offices, and employers hiring junior talent. Recruiting both sides within a focused segment can improve the likelihood of relevant matches during the pilot. Expansion to other industries should follow evidence of recommendation relevance, mutual-match quality, retention, and demand for paid features.

IX. OPERATIONS PLAN

Development and delivery

- Phase 1 — MVP: design and build registration, jobseeker and employer profiles, structured job requirements, recommendation and compatibility logic, swipe-style interest signals, mutual matching, and private messaging. Explainability and required-versus-preferred qualification handling belong in the core product, not only in a later premium release.
- Phase 2 — Pilot: onboard a bounded set of participating employers and early-career jobseekers through institutional partnerships. Gather structured feedback on usability, clarity of scores, recommendation relevance, matching outcomes, and satisfaction; improve the matching logic and user experience based on findings.
- Phase 3 — Expansion: introduce deeper analytics, aggregated talent-pool dashboards, premium access, organization accounts, and wider recruitment segments once core workflows are stable and useful.

Operating workflow

Users create profiles and vacancies → Jumi assesses requirements and preferences → each party reviews recommendations and compatibility explanations → both independently express interest → a mutual match unlocks messaging → parties arrange interviews and assessments outside or through the agreed recruitment process. Jumi facilitates the connection but does not make hiring decisions.

People, infrastructure, and safeguards

The team will prioritize MVP development, dividing responsibilities across engineering, UI/UX design, and business operations based on available expertise. Specialized tasks, including security, legal compliance, and infrastructure management, may require external support. Key resources include hosting, databases, secure communications, analytics, and payment services. Routine operations include moderation, support, system monitoring, security updates, and subscription administration. Personal profiles and private messages require access controls, appropriate retention practices, and compliance with applicable Philippine data protection rules

X. FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

Jumi proposes a preliminary funding requirement of ₱430,000 for six months of MVP development and pilot implementation. Core software development will be undertaken by the team, with external support allocated for specialized development, design, security, and business operations. Funding will also prioritize pilot testing, participant recruitment, infrastructure, and legal compliance to support the platform's initial validation and launch.

Expense Category	**Estimated Cost**
Platform Development and Design	₱120,000
Cloud Hosting, Database, and Infrastructure	₱25,000
Development Tools and Third-Party Services	₱20,000
Pilot Testing and Participant Recruitment	₱70,000
Marketing, Promotions, and User Acquisition	₱35,000
Business Registration, Legal, and Compliance	₱40,000
Business Operations and Professional Consultation	₱45,000
Security Assessment and Technical Consultation	₱35,000
Contingency Fund	₱40,000
Total Estimated Funding	**₱430,000**

The largest allocation supports platform development and design, including specialized technical assistance. Additional funding covers infrastructure, development tools, security, and professional business services. Pilot testing and marketing will prioritize recruiting and engaging both jobseekers and employers, while remaining funds support legal compliance and contingency needs. Potential funding sources include founder contributions, startup competitions, university incubators, government grants, and seed investors.

Subscription and in-app purchases will serve as Jumi's proposed revenue streams for long-term sustainability. Financial projections and budget allocations will be refined based on development requirements, pilot results, and users' willingness to pay.